



ARACHNIDS

Number of species: 102,248

KEY FEATURES



Eight legs



Many make webs

Arachnids are found on land or in fresh water. Their body is divided into two segments—a fused head and thorax and an abdomen. They are mainly carnivorous, pouring digestive enzymes from their stomach over their food before sucking it up into their mouth. Many of them are hunters. Spiders spin webs of silk to trap prey; they also inject prey with venom, as do scorpions. Many arachnids have fine sensory hairs on their body that gives them a sense of touch.

TARANTULA



MITE

TRAP-DOOR SPIDER



ORB WEAVER SPIDER



SCORPION

MOLLUSKS

Number of species: 85,000

KEY FEATURES



Soft body



Unsegmented



Some have shells

Mollusks are a diverse group of organisms with a wide variety of body shapes. Many have a hard outer shell for protection and to support the body. They have a nervous system and a primitive brain, although in octopuses and squid the brain is highly developed. They have tiny toothlike structures called denticles, which they use to scrape algae off rocks or to bore through shells into the flesh of other mollusks. Members of the octopus family are free swimmers—scallops can use jet propulsion. Other mollusks move around on the seabed using a single muscular foot.



GIANT AFRICAN SNAIL



LETTUCE SLUG



SCALLOP



GIANT CLAM

OCTOPUS



CNIDARIANS

Number of species: 11,300

KEY FEATURES



Soft body



Swim by pushing water out of body cavity

Cnidarians are found only in water, and the water supports their body. They can detect light, but don't actually have eyes. Instead they rely on their senses of smell and touch to detect prey and predators. Many are equipped with stinging cells on their tentacles that inject venom and digestive enzymes. Anemones and corals are mainly filter feeders, trapping particles of food with their arms.

ANEMONE



BRAIN CORAL



RED CORAL



DEAD MAN'S FINGERS CORAL



JELLYFISH

